

CSS Specificity – Summary Note

What is CSS Specificity?

CSS Specificity is a set of rules used by browsers to determine which CSS style should be applied when multiple selectors target the same HTML element.

Specificity Hierarchy

1. Inline Styles (1000)
2. ID Selectors (100)
3. Class Selectors, Attributes, Pseudo-classes (10)
4. Element Selectors and Pseudo-elements (1)

Examples

Example 1

CSS:

```
p { color: blue; }  
.text { color: red; }
```

HTML:

Result: Red

Reason: Class specificity (10) is higher than element specificity (1).

Example 2

CSS:

```
.text { color: red; }  
#message { color: green; }
```

HTML:

Result: Green

Reason: ID specificity (100) is higher than class specificity (10).

Tie-Breaking Rule

When two selectors have equal specificity, the selector that appears later in the stylesheet is applied.

Importance of CSS Specificity

- Helps resolve styling conflicts.
- Makes CSS easier to maintain.
- Essential for debugging large projects.
- Important when working with frameworks such as Tailwind CSS and Bootstrap.

Conclusion

Understanding CSS Specificity allows developers to predict which styles will be applied, avoid conflicts, and write cleaner, more maintainable stylesheets.